

(a) A diagnostic protocol for human-attention allocation claims



Protocol rule: a trigger claim is supported only if it survives cost matching, repeated checkpoint evaluation, and trace-level budget diagnosis.

(b) Case-study gate outcomes

Gate Protocol check Evidence readout Protocol verdict

G1 **Cost-matched random frontier** random_b350: +4.6 pp, 25 fewer human steps **Reject claim**

G2 **Repeated checkpoint evaluation** 500 evaluation episodes with Wilson intervals **Audit ranking**

G3 **Trace-level attention diagnosis** 96 vs 55 starts; closer cube geometry **Diagnose spending**

G4 **Same-seed repair stop gate** score-floor: -8.7 pp, +158.3 human steps **Stop repair**

(c) Derived stop-rule metrics

